

THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

ORIGIN LEARNING PLATFORM

LEADERSHIP & INFLUENCE

RESOURCE GUIDE

INFLUENCE PSYCHOLOGY

The Science of Ethical Influence & Human Connection

The greatest leaders do not push people — they pull them.

ZEKI UBOR

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INTRODUCTION | The Science Behind Why People Say Yes

Influence is not manipulation. Influence is not control. Influence is the highest form of service — the art of helping others make decisions that benefit themselves while advancing a shared purpose.

Robert Cialdini, in his landmark work "Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion," identified 6 universal principles that drive human decision-making. The Becoming Institute has integrated these with transformational leadership psychology to create a framework that is both powerful and deeply ethical.

This guide teaches you how to:

- Understand the 7 Core Influence Principles and their neurological basis
- Apply ethical persuasion in professional, leadership, and personal contexts
- Recognize and defend against manipulative influence tactics
- Build the kind of character and trust that makes influence effortless
- Develop your personal "Influence Architecture" — a signature approach to leading others

"Before you can change anyone's mind, you must first earn a place in their heart." — Zeki Ubor

CHAPTER 1 | Cialdini's 6 Principles of Influence

These principles operate at the subconscious level. Understanding them gives you the ability to influence with awareness and defend against their misuse.

1. Reciprocity: People feel compelled to return favors and concessions.

Application: Give genuine value first — knowledge, help, recognition — before asking for anything.

2. Commitment & Consistency: Once people commit to something, they follow through to stay consistent with their self-image.

Application: Ask for small commitments first. These pave the way for larger agreements.

3. Social Proof: People follow the actions of others, especially in uncertain situations.

Application: Testimonials, case studies, and community proof validate your position powerfully.

4. Authority: People defer to credible experts and authoritative sources.

Application: Share your credentials, demonstrate competence, and cite respected sources.

5. Liking: People say yes to those they like. We like those similar to us, who compliment us, and who are familiar.

Application: Find genuine common ground. Use people's names. Show authentic interest.

6. Scarcity: The less available something is, the more desirable it becomes.

Application: Be honest about constraints — limited time, limited availability — never fabricate them.

CHAPTER 2 | Emotional Intelligence: The Foundation of Influence

Daniel Goleman's research on emotional intelligence reveals a stunning fact: IQ accounts for only 20% of career success. The other 80% is determined by emotional intelligence — your ability to understand and manage emotions in yourself and others.

The 5 Pillars of Emotional Intelligence for Influence:

1. Self-Awareness: Knowing your emotional triggers, biases, and default patterns.

Influence Application: Leaders who know themselves project unshakeable stability.

2. Self-Regulation: Managing your emotions rather than reacting to them.

Influence Application: Staying calm under pressure commands deep respect and trust.

3. Motivation: Internal drive that pursues goals beyond external reward.

Influence Application: Intrinsically motivated leaders inspire others to move from obligation to calling.

4. Empathy: Accurately reading the emotional state of others and responding appropriately.

Influence Application: The person who makes you feel understood owns a permanent seat in your mind.

5. Social Skills: Building networks, managing relationships, and navigating conflict masterfully.

Influence Application: Social skill is the delivery system for every other influence principle.

The Becoming Institute Teaching: You cannot sustainably influence anyone you do not genuinely care about. Character is the foundation of influence. Everything else is technique.

CHAPTER 3 | Storytelling: The Most Ancient Influence Technology

Before persuasion techniques, before negotiation frameworks, before PowerPoint — there was the story. Stories bypass analytical resistance and speak directly to the emotional brain. They create shared experience, transport listeners, and anchor beliefs in memorable narratives.

Why Stories Work Neurologically:

When you hear a fact, only the language processing areas of the brain activate. When you hear a story, sensory, motor, and emotional areas light up simultaneously — the brain experiences the story as if it were real.

The Becoming Institute Story Framework (SPEC):

S — Situation: Paint the context. Who, when, where.

P — Problem: What challenge or conflict arose?

E — Emotion: What was felt? This is where connection happens.

C — Change: What transformed? What was learned? What became possible?

Types of Stories Every Influencer Must Master:

1. The Origin Story — Why you do what you do. Your "why."
2. The Transformation Story — A client or personal journey from struggle to breakthrough.
3. The Vision Story — What the future looks like when the shared goal is achieved.
4. The Teaching Story — A principle illustrated through narrative (parables, case studies).

Action Step: Write your personal Origin Story in the SPEC format. Practice telling it in under 90 seconds. This becomes your most powerful influence asset.

CHAPTER 4 | Trust Architecture: Building Influence That Lasts

Stephen M.R. Covey identifies two components of trust: Character (your intentions and integrity) and Competence (your capabilities and results). Both must be present for lasting influence.

The Trust Equation (David Maister):

Trust = (Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) divided by Self-Orientation

Credibility: Do your words hold weight? Do you know what you're talking about?

Reliability: Do you do what you say you'll do? Every time?

Intimacy: Do people feel safe being vulnerable and honest with you?

Self-Orientation: The lower your self-focus, the higher the trust. It is about them, not you.

The Becoming Institute Trust-Building Protocol:

1. Make specific, small promises — then exceed them. Build a track record.
2. Acknowledge your mistakes openly and quickly. Integrity under fire builds unshakeable trust.
3. Give credit generously. People trust those who do not need to steal the spotlight.
4. Listen more than you speak. Silence signals security. Security signals trustworthiness.
5. Remember what matters to people. Reference their goals, names, and stories.

The Compounding Law of Trust: Each kept promise is a deposit in the trust account. Each broken promise is a heavy withdrawal. Build the account consistently — and your influence becomes effortless.

CHAPTER 5 | Ethical Influence vs Manipulation: The Defining Line

The line between influence and manipulation is the single most important distinction in this guide. Crossing it destroys trust, reputation, and ultimately — influence itself.

Influence (Ethical):

- Transparent about intentions
- Serves the other person's genuine interests
- Provides accurate, complete information
- Respects the other person's autonomy to choose
- Sustainable — builds relationship over time

Manipulation (Unethical):

- Conceals true intentions
- Serves only the influencer's interests
- Uses selective, distorted, or false information
- Exploits cognitive biases and emotional vulnerabilities
- Corrosive — destroys trust when discovered

The Becoming Institute Standard Test — Before any influence attempt, ask:

1. If this person knew exactly what I was doing and why, would they still feel respected?
2. Am I presenting accurate information or selectively omitting inconvenient facts?
3. Does saying yes genuinely serve their interests, or only mine?
4. Would I be comfortable if my method was published publicly?

If you cannot answer yes to all four, you have crossed from influence into manipulation.

The Long Game: Ethical influencers build compounding credibility over years. Manipulators gain short-term compliance and lose everything in one exposure.

INFLUENCE IN ACTION — REAL-WORLD APPLICATION MATRIX

Scenario 1 — Presenting an idea to leadership:

Use: Authority (cite data), Social Proof (reference successful precedents), Storytelling (paint the vision).

Avoid: Overselling, withholding risks, pressuring timelines artificially.

Scenario 2 — Motivating a team that has lost momentum:

Use: Empathy (acknowledge the difficulty), Commitment (reconnect to earlier declarations), Vision Story.

Avoid: False urgency, shaming poor performers, forcing enthusiasm.

Scenario 3 — Selling a product or service you believe in:

Use: Reciprocity (give value first), Testimonials (social proof), Scarcity (if genuinely limited).

Avoid: Fake deadlines, exaggerated claims, pressure closes.

Scenario 4 — Navigating a difficult personal conversation:

Use: Active Listening, Empathy, "I" Statements, the SPEC Story framework.

Avoid: Passive-aggression, emotional flooding, premature conclusions.

Scenario 5 — Building authority in your field:

Use: Consistency (publish insights regularly), Authority (demonstrate expertise), Liking (be warm and generous).

Avoid: Boasting, gatekeeping knowledge, positioning against others.

YOUR 21-DAY INFLUENCE DEVELOPMENT PRACTICE

Week 1 — Foundation (Self-Awareness & Trust)

Day 1-2: Identify your current default influence style (Logical? Emotional? Relational?).

Day 3-4: Map your trust accounts: Who trusts you deeply? Where has trust eroded? Why?

Day 5-7: In every conversation, reduce self-orientation. Ask: "What does this person need most?"

Week 2 — Skill Building (Principles & Storytelling)

Day 8-9: Study and identify one Cialdini principle operating in your environment daily.

Day 10-11: Write and practice your personal Origin Story using the SPEC framework.

Day 12-14: In one key relationship, consciously apply the Listen-Mirror-Ask method.

Week 3 — Integration (Application & Character)

Day 15-16: Deliver a meaningful contribution to someone with no expectation of return (Reciprocity).

Day 17-18: In one professional context, demonstrate your competence through results, not claims.

Day 19-20: Identify one area where you have been manipulative rather than influential. Make it right.

Day 21: Write your Personal Influence Manifesto — your ethical commitments as an influencer.

THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

Transforming Individuals. Building Leaders. Shaping Generations.

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This Influence Psychology guide is part of the Origin Communication Skills Track — designed to equip emerging leaders, professionals, and entrepreneurs with the psychological tools to build genuine authority, lasting trust, and ethical influence.

The Becoming Institute teaches that true influence is a byproduct of character, competence, and consistent service to others. Techniques are tools. Character is the foundation.

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